“Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta”

Ādi-līlā

Chapter 7

Setting Forth the Account of the Pañca-tattva

(English translation from the Bengali, following the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition and the Anubhāṣya, 2026)

1 I bow to Śrī Caitanya, the only refuge of those who have no other refuge, who gives the highest treasure to those bereft of every good. Now I write of the magnanimity with which He bestows love and devotion for Kṛṣṇa.[1]

2 Glory, glory to Mahāprabhu Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya! Whoever takes shelter at His feet is truly blessed.

3 At the beginning I offered obeisance to the six truths, headed by the guru. I have spoken of the truth of the guru; now I shall consider the other five.[2]

4 The five truths descended together with Śrī Caitanya, and with them He delights in saṅkīrtana.

5 The five truths are one substance; there is no difference between them at all. Yet to taste rasa, the one truth appears in different forms.[3]

6 “I bow to Kṛṣṇa, who is manifest as five truths — the Pañca-tattva: as a devotee in form and a devotee in essence, as the incarnation of a devotee, as the one called a devotee, and as the potency of devotion.” (Śrī Rūpa Gosvāmī)[4]

7 Kṛṣṇa is Bhagavān Himself, the one Lord of all. He has no equal; He is the son of Nanda and the crown of all who relish rasa.

8 He enjoys the rāsa dance and His other pastimes and is the beloved of the maidens of Vraja; all the others you see are His associates.

9 That same Kṛṣṇa has descended as Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya, and with Him have come all those associates, every one of them blessed.

10 Lord Caitanya alone is the Supreme Lord, yet His pure, spiritual body is filled with the sentiment of a devotee.[5]

11 Kṛṣṇa's sweetness has one wondrous property: to taste Himself, He takes on the sentiment of His own devotee.[6]

12 That is why Caitanya Gosāñi appears in the mood of a devotee, and His brother Nityānanda is the devotee in essence (*bhakta-svarūpa*).

13 Advaita Ācārya is His incarnation as a devotee (*bhakta-avatāra*). These three truths we all glorify as the Lord — as Prabhu.

14 One is Mahāprabhu, and the other two are Prabhus; the two Prabhus serve the feet of Mahāprabhu.

15 These three truths we accept as worshipable by all; the fourth, the truth of the devotee, we know as the worshipper.[7]

16 The countless millions of devotees headed by Śrīvāsa are all counted among the pure devotees (*śuddha-bhakta*).

17 Gadādhara Paṇḍita and others are incarnations of the Lord's potency (*śakti*); they are counted as His intimate devotees.[8]

18–19 With them the Lord enjoys His eternal pastimes, with them He spreads the kīrtana, with them He tastes prema, and with them He gives away the treasure of prema.[9]

20–21 Coming to earth together, the five truths broke the seal of the ancient storehouse of prema. Together they plunder that love and taste it, and the more they drink, the more their thirst grows at every moment.[10]

22 Again and again they give it to others to drink and grow wild with love; they dance, weep, laugh and sing as though intoxicated.

23 They make no distinction between the fit and the unfit, nor between a proper place and an improper one: wherever they find anyone, there they give prema.

24 Plundering, tasting and giving, they empty the storehouse; yet so wondrous is this storehouse that the prema in it grows a hundredfold.

25 The flood of prema surged and spread on every side, drowning everyone — women and old men, boys and youths.

26 The good and the wicked, the lame, the dull and the blind — the flood of prema engulfed all the people of the world.

27 The world was drowned, and the seed of the jīvas' bondage was destroyed. Seeing this, the five felt the highest joy.[11]

28 The more the five pour down the rain of prema, the higher the waters rise, until they fill the three worlds.

29–30 But the Māyāvādīs, those devoted to fruitive work, the false logicians, the blasphemers, the pāṣaṇḍīs and the lowest of students — all these,

being very clever, ran away, and the flood could not touch them.[12]

31–32 Seeing this, Mahāprabhu reflected: “I tried to drown the whole world, but some have escaped, and My vow has been broken. To drown them too, I shall devise a playful ruse.”

33 Saying this and deliberating within Himself, the Lord accepted the order of sannyāsa.

34 For twenty-four years He lived as a householder; in His twenty-fifth year He took up the dharma of a renunciant.[13]

35 Having taken sannyāsa, the Lord drew to Himself all who had fled — the logicians and the rest.

36 Students, pāṣaṇḍīs, karmīs, blasphemers and all the others came and bowed down at the Lord’s feet.

37 He forgave their offences, and they sank into the waters of prema. Who can escape the Lord’s great net of love?

38 The Lord is the avatāra of mercy who came to deliver everyone, and to that end He devises countless stratagems.

39 He made His devotees of all — even the mlecchas and others; only the Māyāvādīs of Kāśī escaped.

40 On His way to Vṛndāvana the Lord stayed in Kāśī, and the Māyāvādīs began to blaspheme Him:

41 “Though a sannyāsī, He sings and dances. He does not hear Vedānta, but performs saṅkīrtana.[14]

42 This foolish sannyāsī does not know His own dharma; a sentimentalist Himself, He wanders about with sentimentalists."

43 Hearing all this, the Lord smiled within, and, paying no heed, He spoke with none of them.

44 Disregarding them, He went on to Mathurā, and after seeing it He came back again.

45 In Kāśī lived the scribe Śrī Candraśekhara, a śūdra, and the Lord, supremely independent, stayed in his house.[15]

46 He took His meals at the house of Tapana Miśra and accepted no invitation in the company of the sannyāsīs.

47 Sanātana Gosāñi came and met Him there, and to instruct him the Lord stayed two months.

48 He taught him the whole dharma of the Vaiṣṇavas and all the hidden heart of the *Bhāgavata* and the other scriptures.

49 Meanwhile Candraśekhara and Tapana Miśra, deeply grieved, came to the Lord's feet with a petition:

50 "How much longer must we hear You blasphemed, O Lord? We cannot bear it; we would rather give up our lives.

51 All the sannyāsīs revile You, and we cannot listen to it: our hearts and ears are bursting."

52 Hearing this, the Lord only smiled a little. Just then a brāhmaṇa came to meet Him.

53 He came and, clasping the Lord's feet, made his petition: "I beg one thing of You; be pleased and grant it.

54 I have invited all the sannyāsīs; if You come too, my heart's desire will be fulfilled.

55 I know that You do not go to gatherings of sannyāsīs; yet be merciful to me and accept my invitation."

56 Smiling, the Lord accepted the invitation; He made this gesture to show mercy to the sannyāsīs.

57 The brāhmaṇa knew that the Lord does not go to anyone's house, but, inspired by the Lord Himself, he pressed Him with great insistence.[16]

58 The next day the Lord went to the brāhmaṇa's house and saw the sannyāsīs all seated there.

59 Bowing to them all, He went to wash His feet, and when He had washed them He sat down in that very place.

60 As He sat there, He revealed a little of His majesty: His body shone with great effulgence, with the splendour of millions of suns.[17]

61 That splendour drew the minds of all the sannyāsīs, and they all rose from their seats.

62 The chief among the sannyāsīs, Prakāśānanda by name, addressed the Lord with respect:[18]

63 "Come here, Gosāñi; listen, Śrīpāda. You are sitting in an impure place — why are You so downcast?"

64 The Lord replied, “I belong to a lower sampradāya; it is not fitting for Me to sit in your assembly.”[19]

65 Then Prakāśānanda himself took Him by the hand and, with respect, seated Him in the midst of the assembly.

66 He asked, “Your name is Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya, is it not? You are a disciple of Keśava Bhāratī, and so You are worthy of glory.

67 You are a sannyāsī of our own sampradāya and You live in this town; why then do You not come to see us?

68 Though You are a sannyāsī, You dance and sing, and You take all these sentimentalists with You and perform kīrtana.

69 The study of Vedānta and meditation are the dharma of a sannyāsī; why do You abandon them and do the work of sentimentalists?

70 From Your splendour we see that You are Nārāyaṇa Himself; why then do You behave so lowly? What is the reason?”

71 The Lord said, “Listen, Śrīpāda, to the reason for this. My guru saw that I was a fool, and he chastised Me:[20]

72 ‘You are a fool; You are not qualified for Vedānta. Always chant the Kṛṣṇa-mantra — it is the essence of all mantras.

73 From the Kṛṣṇa-mantra will come release from saṁsāra, and by Kṛṣṇa’s name You will attain Kṛṣṇa’s feet.[21]

74 In the age of Kali there is no dharma other than the name; the name is the essence of all mantras — this is the heart of the scriptures.’

75 Saying this, he taught Me a verse: ‘Keep this verse on Your lips and reflect on it.’

76 “The name of Hari, the name of Hari, the name of Hari alone! In the age of Kali there is no other way, there is no other way, there is no other way.” (Bṛhan-nāradīya Purāṇa, 38.126)[22]

77 Receiving this order, I took the name constantly, and as I chanted on and on, My mind grew bewildered.

78 I could no longer keep My composure; I became mad. I laughed and wept, I danced and sang like one intoxicated.

79 Then, gathering My composure, I reflected: ‘Kṛṣṇa’s name has covered all My knowledge.

80 I have gone mad; there is no composure left in My mind.’ Thinking this, I came to the feet of My guru and said:

81 ‘What mantra have you given Me, Gosāñi? What power it has! Chanting it again and again, I have gone mad.

82 It makes Me laugh, it makes Me dance, it makes Me weep.’ Hearing this, My guru spoke these words to Me:

83 ‘Such is the nature of the great mantra, Kṛṣṇa’s name: it awakens *bhāva* for Kṛṣṇa in whoever chants it.[23]

84 Prema for Kṛṣṇa is the supreme aim of human life; before it the four other goals are like straw.

85 The fifth goal of life is prema, a boundless ocean of nectarean bliss; the bliss of Brahman and all the rest is not equal to a single drop of it.[24]

86 All the scriptures say that the fruit of Kṛṣṇa's name is prema, and by good fortune that prema has dawned in You.

87 It is the nature of prema to stir both mind and body and to awaken a burning longing to attain Kṛṣṇa's feet.

88 Moved by prema, the devotee laughs, weeps and sings; as if mad, he dances and runs here and there.[25]

89–90 Perspiration, trembling, hair standing on end, tears, a faltering voice and change of colour; madness, despondency, steadiness, pride, joy and humility — with all these feelings prema makes the devotees dance and sets them afloat on the ocean of the nectar of Kṛṣṇa's bliss.

91 It is good that You have attained the supreme goal of life; by Your prema my own life has been fulfilled.

92 Dance, sing and perform saṅkīrtana with the devotees; teach Kṛṣṇa's name and deliver all people.'[26]

93 Saying this, he taught Me a verse and told Me again and again: 'This is the essence of the *Bhāgavata*.'

94 "One who has taken this vow, chanting the names of his beloved Lord, finds love awakening within him; his heart melts, and, heedless of the world, he laughs aloud, weeps, cries out, sings and dances like a madman." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 11.2.40)[27]

95 With firm faith in these words of his, I constantly perform the saṅkīrtana of Kṛṣṇa's name.

96 That name of Kṛṣṇa sometimes makes Me sing and dance; I do not sing and dance of My own will.[28]

97 Before the ocean of bliss tasted in Kṛṣṇa's name, the bliss of Brahman is like water in a ditch.

98 "O Guru of the world, now that I am immersed in the pure ocean of joy that comes from seeing You face to face, all other joys — even the bliss of Brahman — seem to me like the water in a calf's hoofprint." (Hari-bhakti-sudhodaya, 14.36)

99 Hearing the Lord's sweet words, the sannyāsīs had a change of heart, and they answered Him with gentle words:

100 "All that You have said is true: love for Kṛṣṇa is attained only by one whose good fortune has dawned.

101 You have devotion for Kṛṣṇa, and we are all pleased with that. But why do You not hear Vedānta? What fault is there in it?"[29]

102 Hearing this, the Lord smiled and said, "If you will not take offence, I shall explain."

103 At this all the sannyāsīs said, "We see You as Nārāyaṇa Himself.

104 Your words soothe our ears, and the sight of Your sweetness soothes our eyes.

105 Your presence has filled all our hearts with joy, and Your words are never unfitting."

106 The Lord said, “The *Vedānta-sūtra* is the word of the Lord: Śrī Nārāyaṇa Himself composed it in the form of Vyāsa.[30]

107 Error, inattention, the wish to deceive and the imperfection of the senses — none of these faults is found in the words of the Lord.

108 The truth that the sūtras declare together with the Upaniṣads is of supreme greatness when taken in its primary sense.[31]

109 But to hear the commentary that the Ācārya wrote in the secondary sense is to lose every spiritual gain.

110 The fault is not his: he received the Lord’s order and so gave the secondary meaning, covering the primary.[32]

111 In its primary sense the word “Brahman” means Bhagavān, full of spiritual majesty, with none above Him or equal to Him.

112 His opulence and His body are all spiritual in form; but, covering His spiritual opulence, the Ācārya calls Him “formless”.

113 His body, His abode and His retinue are spiritual bliss, yet they say that He is a transformation of material *sattva*.

114 The fault is not his, for he is a servant who carries out orders; but whoever listens to him meets with utter ruin.

115 One who regards the body of Viṣṇu as material commits the gravest blasphemy against Viṣṇu; there is none greater than this.

116 The truth of the Lord is like a blazing fire, and the jīva in its true nature is like a particle of a spark.

117 The jīva is a potency (*śakti*); Kṛṣṇa is the possessor of all potency (*śaktimān*). The *Gītā*, the *Viṣṇu Purāṇa* and other scriptures bear witness to this.

118 “This nature is inferior. But know, O mighty-armed, that I have another, superior nature, consisting of the jīvas, who take up this world for their own enjoyment.” (Bhagavad-gītā, 7.5)[33]

119 “The potency of Viṣṇu is declared to be superior; the potency called the knower of the field (*kṣetrajña*) is likewise superior; and the other, called ignorance and karma, is held to be a third potency.” (Viṣṇu Purāṇa, 6.7.61)[34]

120 Yet the Ācārya took such a jīva and declared it to be the Supreme Truth, and so he hid the supreme greatness of the Lord.[35]

121 In Vyāsa’s sūtras the doctrine of transformation (*pariṇāma-vāda*) is taught; but Śaṅkara said that Vyāsa was mistaken and raised a dispute.[36]

122 He argued that under the doctrine of transformation the Lord would be subject to change, and on that ground he established *vivarta-vāda*, the doctrine of illusion.[37]

123 In truth the doctrine of transformation alone is authoritative; illusion lies in taking the body for the self.[38]

124 Śrī Bhagavān possesses inconceivable potency, and by His own will He is transformed into the world.[39]

125 Yet by that same inconceivable potency He remains unchanged. We find an example of this even in this world — the *cintāmaṇi* stone.

126 Heaps of various jewels come from the *cintāmaṇi*, yet the gem itself remains unchanged in its nature.

127 If even a material thing possesses inconceivable power, what wonder is there in the inconceivable potency of the Lord?

128 The *praṇava* (oṁ) is the great utterance, the source of the Vedas; the *praṇava* is the Lord Himself in sound, the abode of all the universes.[40]

129 The *praṇava* points to the Lord, the shelter of all, whereas the utterance *tat tvam asi* is one particular statement of the Veda.[41]

130 The *praṇava* is the great utterance; but he covered this and set up *tat tvam asi* as the great utterance instead.

131 All the Vedas and sūtras name Kṛṣṇa in their primary sense; but he abandoned the primary sense and explained them by the secondary one (*lakṣaṇā*).[42]

132 The Veda is self-evident, the crest-jewel of all proofs; interpreted by the secondary sense, it loses that self-evidence.

133 So in every sūtra he abandoned the natural meaning and explained it by a secondary one, inventing it all himself."

134 In this way He showed the faults in the commentary on every sūtra, and the sannyāsīs were astonished to hear it.

135 All the sannyāsīs said, "Listen, Śrīpāda: the meaning You have refuted is beyond dispute.[43]

136 We all know that the meaning is the Ācārya's own invention; yet out of deference to our sampradāya we accept it as the truth.

137 Explain the primary meaning; let us see Your power." And the Lord set about explaining all the sūtras in their primary meaning:

138 "The great reality called Brahman is Śrī Bhagavān, full of the six kinds of majesty, the abode of the Supreme Truth.[44]

139 In His own form and majesty there is not a trace of māyā; in all the Vedas Bhagavān is the *sambandha* — the One to whom everything is related.

140 To call Him featureless (*nirviśeṣa*) is to deny His spiritual potency; and one who does not accept half of His being diminishes His fullness.[45]

141 The means by which one attains Bhagavān is devotion beginning with hearing; it is what brings one to Kṛṣṇa.

142 All the Vedas call this the *abhidheya*, the means to be practised; from devotion in practice (*sādhana-bhakti*) prema springs up.[46]

143 When deep attachment for Kṛṣṇa's feet arises, no attachment to anything other than Kṛṣṇa remains.

144 That great treasure of prema is the fifth goal of life; it lets one taste the rasa of Kṛṣṇa's sweetness.[47]

145 By prema Kṛṣṇa comes under the control of His devotee, and by prema one tastes the joy of serving Kṛṣṇa.

146 *Sambandha*, *abhidheya* and *prayojana* — relationship, means and goal: in these three meanings all the sūtras find their conclusion."[48]

147 Hearing all the sūtras explained in this way, all the sannyāsīs humbly said:

148 "You are the Vedas embodied — Nārāyaṇa Himself. Forgive us for having blasphemed You before."

149 From that time the sannyāsīs' hearts were changed, and they always took the name "Kṛṣṇa, Kṛṣṇa".

150 So He forgave their offences and graced them all with Kṛṣṇa's name.

151 Then all the sannyāsīs took their meal together with Mahāprabhu, seating Him in their midst.

152 After the meal Mahāprabhu returned to His lodging. Such are the wonderful pastimes of the beautiful Gaurāṅga.

153 Candraśekhara, Tapana Miśra and Sanātana rejoiced at heart to hear and see all this.

154 All the sannyāsīs came to see the Lord, and all Vārāṇasī sang His praises.

155 Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya had come to Vārāṇasī, and the city and all its people were greatly blessed.

156 People came in their hundreds of thousands to see the Lord; there was such a crowd at the door that no one could get in.

157 Whenever the Lord went to see Viśveśvara, hundreds of thousands of people gathered there.

158 When He went to bathe on the bank of the Gaṅgā, there too all the people thronged in a great crowd.

159 Raising His arms, the Lord would say, “Chant ‘Hari! Hari!’”, and the people’s cry of “Hari!” filled heaven and earth.

160 Having delivered the people, the Lord decided to leave, and He sent Śrī Sanātana to Vṛndāvana.

161 Hearing the clamour of the crowds night and day, the Lord left Vārāṇasī and returned to Nīlācala.

162 I shall tell these pastimes in detail later; here I have told them briefly, as the occasion arose.[49]

163 Thus, in the form of the Pañca-tattva, Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya blessed the whole world, giving everyone Kṛṣṇa’s name and love for Him.

164 He sent Rūpa and Sanātana to Mathurā, and these two commanders spread bhakti there.

165 He sent Nityānanda Gosāñi to the land of Gauḍa, and there He preached bhakti in every possible way.

166 He Himself went to the south and spread Kṛṣṇa’s name from village to village.

167 As far as Setubandha He preached bhakti, and, giving Kṛṣṇa-prema, He delivered everyone.

168 Thus I have given the explanation of the Pañca-tattva; by hearing it one comes to know the truth of Caitanya.

169 Śrī Caitanya, Nityānanda and Advaita — the three; Śrīvāsa, Gadādhara and all the other devotees —

170 at the lotus feet of all of them I bow millions of times, and as best I can I tell something of Caitanya's pastimes.

171 Praying at the feet of Śrī Rūpa and Śrī Raghunātha, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa, narrate the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*.

Notes

1. *Anubhāṣya*: *agaty-eka-gati* — "the one refuge of those who have no other shelter"; *hīnārthādhika-sādhaka* — "He who grants to those deprived of the supreme good (*paramārtha*) something greater still — the fifth goal of life, love for Kṛṣṇa". ↩
2. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: in the first chapter the truth of the guru was described — as the initiating and the instructing guru; the six truths are those of the verse *vande gurūn īśa-bhaktān* (Ādi 1.1), and now the remaining five are examined. ↩
3. *Anubhāṣya*: in substance the five truths are one, without duality, but for the sake of the pastimes and the tasting of rasa the one truth is fivefold. The devotee in form, the devotee in essence and the incarnation of a devotee are the Lord Himself, His *prakāśa* and His *aṁśa* (*viṣṇu-tattva*); the potency of devotion and the pure devotee are potencies non-different from Him, who serve Him. Without either the worshipped or the worshipper there would be no pastime of tasting rasa. ↩
4. According to the *Anubhāṣya*: the devotee in form is Śrī Gaurāṅga, who tastes His own sweetness; the devotee in essence (in the form of His brother) is Śrī Nityānanda; the devotee-avatāra is Śrī Advaita; the one called a devotee is Śrīvāsa and others, established in *śānta*, *dāsya* and the other rasas; the potency is Gadādhara, Svarūpa Dāmodara, Rāmānanda and others. The same verse as Ādi 1.14; ascribed in the edition to Śrī Rūpa Gosvāmī. ↩

5. The edition's heading: "Though He is the Lord of all, Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya is full of the mood of one who is subordinate." *Anubhāṣya*: Śrī Caitanya is the one Supreme Lord of all conscious beings (*nityo nityānām…*); though non-different from the son of the king of Vraja, He takes a form full of the mood of serving Kṛṣṇa. That form must not be thought of as a body for worldly enjoyment or counted among the jīvas of this world: it is manifest in pure *sattva* (*viśuddha-sattva*) and is revealed to a heart illumined by it. ↩
6. The edition's heading: "To taste His own sweetness, Kṛṣṇa descends as Gaura — 'in the form of a devotee'." *Anubhāṣya*: Kṛṣṇa, the abode of all sweetness, though He is Himself the object of love (*viṣaya*), takes on the sentiment of its subject (*āśraya*) and tastes the joy of serving Himself; yet Śrī Caitanya is not merely a form of the *āśraya*: He is the original Lord Himself (*svayaṁ-rūpa*). ↩
7. *Anubhāṣya*: Śrī Mahāprabhu is the highest Truth, above all, while Śrī Nityānanda and Śrī Advaita are *īśvara-tattvas* subordinate to Him; all three are worshipable by everyone else. The fourth truth is the pure devotees, the fifth the intimate (*antaraṅga*) devotees; both are worshippers. The two worshipable truths, though the last two worship them, are themselves engaged in the service of Śrī Gaurāṅga. ↩
8. *Anubhāṣya*: the truths of *śakti* — the intimate devotees — abide in *madhura-rasa*, which includes *vātsalya*, *sakhya* and *dāsya*; the servants of Śrī Nityānanda and Śrī Advaita, the pure devotees, usually abide in *vātsalya*, *sakhya*, *dāsya* and *śānta*. When their love for Śrī Gaurasundara grows intense, they take shelter of *madhura-rasa* under the guidance of the intimate devotees. Pure devotees are those who, free from other desires, do not cover their service to Kṛṣṇa with karma or jñāna; the intimate devotees are those wholly given to *madhura-rasa* alone. ↩
9. *Anubhāṣya*: "with them" — with all four: with His *prakāśa* (Śrī Nityānanda), with the avatāra of the Puruṣa (Śrī Advaita), with the intimate devotees and with the pure devotees. The edition's heading: "With the four truths — the Lord's pastimes, preaching, tasting and giving." ↩
10. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: the storehouse of prema is the pastimes of Śrī Kṛṣṇa. It had come into the world before, but it was locked and sealed; in the descent of Śrī Caitanya the Pañca-tattva broke the seal, threw open the doors and tasted prema, plundering it. ↩
11. *Anubhāṣya*: in the Lord's *jīva-śakti*, together with the inclination towards Kṛṣṇa, there lies hidden the seed of the desire to enjoy in turning away from Him. As a seed in flooded earth can put forth no shoot, so in the flood of prema

the seed of every desire other than service to Kṛṣṇa perished. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: there perished the seed of the bondage of *avidyā* — the soul's forgetfulness that it is Kṛṣṇa's servant. ↩

12. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: the Māyāvādīs are the sannyāsīs Prakāśānanda and others; those devoted to karma — Devānanda and other karmīs without bhakti, the *smārtas*, for whom karma and its fruits are the chief goal; the false logicians — Sārvabhauma and other godless logicians; the blasphemers — the one whom the Lord drove away with a stick, Gopāla Cāpāla and others who reviled the Lord and His devotees; the pāṣaṇḍīs — those who place other gods on a level with the Lord; the lowest of students — those for whom learning is only a cause for argument and not a way to God. ↩
13. *Anubhāṣya*: Śrī Mahāprabhu accepted sannyāsa in Śaka 1432, in the month of Māgha, during the bright fortnight, at Katwa, from the *daṇḍi-svāmī* Śrī Keśava Bhāratī of the school of Śrī Śaṅkara (under the Śṛṅgerī Maṭha in the south). ↩
14. *Anubhāṣya*: by the rule of the *smṛti*, a sannyāsī must give up singing, dancing and playing music and always study Vedānta; seeing that Mahāprabhu did not hear Śaṅkara's Māyāvāda but danced in love, absorbed in singing of Kṛṣṇa, the sannyāsīs of Kāśī took Him to be ignorant of the dharma of sannyāsa. ↩
15. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: Candraśekhara was a *vaidya*, and so by varṇa a śūdra. It is not proper for a sannyāsī to spend the night in a śūdra's house, but Mahāprabhu stayed with him out of mercy, for He is the independent Lord: before His mercy brāhmaṇa and śūdra are equal. ↩
16. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: wishing to show mercy to the sannyāsīs, the Lord Himself moved the brāhmaṇa's heart, and so he begged with such insistence. ↩
17. As in the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition: «কোটীসূর্য্যাভাস» (another reading: «কোটিসূর্য্যাভাস»); the sense is the same. ↩
18. *Anubhāṣya* (on 7.149): Prakāśānanda Sarasvatī was then the leader of the sannyāsīs of Śaṅkara's school in Kāśī. Some mistakenly identify him with Prabodhānanda Sarasvatī, the author of the *Caitanya-candrāmṛta* and the *Rādhā-rasa-sudhā-nidhi*, but they are different persons. ↩
19. *Anubhāṣya*: of the ten names of sannyāsīs instituted by Śaṅkarācārya, "Tīrtha", "Āśrama" and "Sarasvatī" are held higher than the rest. Mahāprabhu had taken sannyāsa in the "Bhāratī" line and therefore called Prakāśānanda Sarasvatī's school the higher one. In this way He showed the humility of a Vaiṣṇava sannyāsī, who seeks no honour for himself and gives honour to others. ↩

20. *Anubhāṣya*: Śrī Caitanya, Himself the sole object of the Vedānta, teaches who is fit to study it: one who is humbler than a blade of grass, more tolerant than a tree, who seeks no honour and gives honour to others. In calling Himself a fool, He, the Lord of the fourteen worlds, shows the humility of a disciple; the real fool is one who judges the object of the Vedānta by the mind and senses. ↩
21. *Anubhāṣya* (after the *Bhakti-sandarbha*, 284): the mantras too are names of the Lord, adorned with the word *namaḥ* and the like, and the sages have placed a special power in them; the name alone, depending on nothing else, is able to give the highest goal of life. Initiation is needed to curb the impure tendencies of those whose minds are attached to the body and restless. ↩
22. *Anubhāṣya*: in Satya-yuga the way is meditation, in Tretā sacrifice, in Dvāpara the worship of the Deity; in Kali there is none of these — there is only one way, the name of Hari; all other means are fruitless in Kali. ↩
23. *Anubhāṣya* (on 7.74): “Hare Kṛṣṇa Hare Kṛṣṇa Kṛṣṇa Kṛṣṇa Hare Hare / Hare Rāma Hare Rāma Rāma Rāma Hare Hare — these sixteen names destroy the impurity of Kali; no higher means is to be found in all the Vedas” (*Kali-santaraṇa Upaniṣad*). On 7.83: the mantras of the Pañcarātra are called simply mantras, while the names of the Lord are called the *mahā-mantra*. ↩
24. As in the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition: «ব্রহ্মাদি আনন্দ» (“the bliss of Brahman and the rest”; the heading: “Prema, which puts liberation and the rest to shame, is the fifth goal of life”). *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: even the bliss of Brahman, the first stage of liberation, cannot be compared with a single drop of prema. Other editions read «মোক্ষাদি» (“liberation and the rest”). ↩
25. *Anubhāṣya*: when those without prema display laughter, tears, dancing and singing, it is only a sign of their misfortune; one who performs bhajana must reject altogether any artificial agitation of body and senses. The laughter, tears, singing, dancing and longing born of *bhāva* and prema come when the natural function of the soul awakens; they are the guileless movements of one turned towards service. The presumption of one who, without prema, assumes the high station of a devotee brings only harm into the world. ↩
26. *Anubhāṣya*: to those whom Gurudeva sees to be qualified he gives the right to dance, sing and perform saṅkīrtana with like-minded devotees, and they, following in his steps, serve the deliverance of the world; the unqualified should chant Kṛṣṇa’s name in solitude. ↩
27. *Anubhāṣya*: these words were spoken by Kavi, one of the nine Yogendras, to King Nimi. *Evaṁ-vrataḥ* — one whose vow is the service of hearing, chanting and the like; *druta-cittaḥ* — with a heart full of longing; *loka-bāhyaḥ* — indifferent to people’s laughter, blame or praise. ↩

28. *Anubhāṣya*: Śrī Nāma Prabhu Himself, by His own will, moved Śrī Gaurasundara to sing and dance; Gaurasundara did not chant the name as though it were a thing of this world. Those who, driven by restless senses, make the name their plaything and try to lord it over Him, reap only the fruits of karma instead of bhajana. ↩
29. The edition's heading to 7.100–101: "Even so — only ordinary regard for bhakti, but firm faith in Māyāvāda." *Anubhāṣya*: the Māyāvādīs are pleased when Kṛṣṇa is served with body and mind as a temporary practice, for they consider bhakti a kind of karma; and by "Vedānta" they mean the Upaniṣads and the *Brahma-sūtra* as interpreted by Śaṅkara. ↩
30. As in the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition: «তাহা» ("it"; another reading «যাহা», "which"); the sense is the same. *Anubhāṣya*: the Vedas came into the world from the breath of Śrī Nārāyaṇa; Śrī Vyāsa, who composed the sūtras, is His empowered avatāra (*śaktyāveśa*), and so the sūtras too are the word of Nārāyaṇa Himself. ↩
31. The edition's heading: "In the primary sense (*abhidhā*) the object of the Vedānta is Bhagavān, the Truth endowed with attributes." *Anubhāṣya*: the primary sense (*mukhya-vṛtti*, *abhidhā*) is what a word means by dictionary and grammar; the secondary sense (*gauṇa-vṛtti*, *lakṣaṇā*) is another meaning connected with it, resorted to out of some need. ↩
32. The edition's heading to 7.109: "Hearing Śaṅkara's commentary, composed in the secondary sense to bewilder the asuras, brings ruin." *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: Śaṅkara, an avatāra of Śiva, was carrying out the Lord's will, and therefore he is not at fault. In the *Padma Purāṇa* Śiva says: "Māyāvāda is a false doctrine, Buddhism in disguise. In the age of Kali I Myself, in the form of a brāhmaṇa, shall set it forth to bewilder the world." ↩
33. *Anubhāṣya*: *yayā* — "by that conscious potency called the jīva"; *dhāryate* — "is taken up for one's own enjoyment". *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: earth, water, fire, air, ether, mind, intelligence and false ego make up the inferior nature, māyā; the other, superior nature is the jīvas, and māyā has no part in forming the jīva — only its seeming material self belongs to māyā. ↩
34. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: Viṣṇu's potency is threefold: the superior (*parā*) is the spiritual potency (*cit-śakti*); the *kṣetrajña* is the jīva potency; that called ignorance and karma is *māyā*. ↩
35. The edition's heading: "To take the Lord, like the jīva, as subject to ignorance is also Māyāvāda." *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: the jīva is a particular potency of the Lord; if it is established not as a particle of consciousness (*aṇu-caitanya*) but as Brahman, the doctrine is bound to be mistaken. ↩

36. The edition's heading: "The *Brahma-sūtra* accepts *śakti-pariṇāma-vāda*, the doctrine of the transformation of the potency." ↩
37. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: Śaṅkara argued that by *pariṇāma-vāda* the Lord would have to be called changeable, and that to accept it would be to call Vyāsa mistaken; so he established *vivarta-vāda* (in his commentary on *Brahma-sūtra* 2.1.14). But in the sūtras the transformation is the work of the Lord's inconceivable potency, acting by His will alone. ↩
38. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: *vivarta* is taking a thing for what it is not, "like a rope for a snake". The jīva is a pure particle of spirit, and when, embodied as a human being, it takes this body for its self, that is *vivarta*. To transfer this fault to the world and to the jīva, calling them false, is groundless: both the world and the jīva are real, coming from the real Brahman. ↩
39. The edition's heading to 7.127: "Though His potency is transformed, He Himself remains unchanged." *Anubhāṣya* (after Śrī Jīva Gosvāmī's *Paramātma-sandarbha*, 58): it is not the essence (*svarūpa*) of the Supreme that is transformed but His potency called *dravya*, which is the expansion of His essence; He Himself, by His inconceivable potency, remains unchanged, like the *cintāmaṇi* or the lodestone, which, without changing, produce jewels or move iron. The world therefore is not false: what is false is only the identification of the self with the body. ↩
40. *Anubhāṣya*: oṁ, the *praṇava*, is the great utterance, the source of the Vedas; it stands at the beginning and at the end of every Vedic mantra and is the Lord Himself in sound: "The sound *a* denotes Kṛṣṇa, the one Lord of all the worlds; *u* denotes Rādhā; and *m* the jīva." ↩
41. The edition's heading: "The Lord is the denoted, the *praṇava* the denoting; *tat tvam asi* and the like point only to one part of the Veda." *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: a great utterance (*mahā-vākya*) is one that embraces the whole Veda; *tat tvam asi* (*Chāndogya Upaniṣad* 6.8.7) applies only to one part of it. ↩
42. *Anubhāṣya*: "In the Vedas, in the *Rāmāyaṇa*, in the Purāṇas and in the *Mahābhārata* — at the beginning, in the middle and at the end — Hari alone is sung everywhere." ↩
43. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: "O Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya, the reasoning by which You have refuted Śaṅkara's meaning is no idle quarrel: a fortunate person accepts it as the truth." ↩
44. The edition's heading: "The Lord's explanation: (1) Bhagavān Kṛṣṇa is the *sambandha*." *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: in the *Bṛhad-āraṇyaka Upaniṣad* (*pūrṇam adaḥ…*, 5.1) the Supreme Truth, full of the six opulences, is called

"the great reality"; the Purāṇas describe the same marks by the word "Bhagavān". So wherever the Vedas say "Brahman", the word fulfils its meaning when it is understood as Śrī Bhagavān. ↩

45. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: Bhagavān, embracing the featureless aspect within Himself, is eternally endowed with attributes; to call Him featureless is not to accept His *cit-śakti*. Brahman possesses spiritual potency and is therefore personal; one who does not accept half of His being diminishes His fullness. ↩
46. The edition's heading to 7.141: "(2) *Sādhana-bhakti*, beginning with hearing, is the means — the *abhidheya*." *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: to attain the shelter of Bhagavān's feet, all the Vedas prescribe *sādhana-bhakti*; from its nine forms, beginning with hearing, Kṛṣṇa-prema springs up. ↩
47. The edition's heading to 7.143: "(3) Kṛṣṇa-prema is the goal (*prayojana*), the fifth aim of life." ↩
48. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: knowledge of *sambandha* is the answer to the questions: who am I, what is this world, who is Bhagavān and what is our relationship; *abhidheya* is what one must do, having learned this; *prayojana* is the fruit of that endeavour. *Anubhāṣya* (on 7.106): the first two chapters of the *Vedānta-sūtra* speak of *sambandha*, the third of *abhidheya*, *sādhana-bhakti*, the fourth of *prayojana*, love for Bhagavān; the natural commentary on the sūtras, written by Vyāsa himself, is the *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*. ↩
49. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: "later" — see *Madhya-līlā*, chapter 25. ↩